TERRORISM: A THREAT TO INTERNATIONAL PEACE AND SECURITY

The terms, *terrorism* and *terrorist* are used very frequently in the present day world but their origin can be traced to the French Revolution when they were used to mean different persons/events of that time. The 1798 supplement of the *Dictionnaire of the Académie Française* gave the meaning of terrorism as *système, régime de la terreur*. These terms referred to that period of French Revolution between 1793–1794, identified as the *Reign of Terror*. Later, it came to acquire a much broader connotation and one of the few attempts made to define and explain 'terrorism' has been that of Hardman's entry in the *Encyclopedia of Social Sciences* published in 1930s. Here he tried to define terrorism as the method (or the theory behind the method), which an organized group or party sought to achieve its avowed aims chiefly through the systematic use of violence.[1] The central point is that terrorism is an act which uses violence to achieve its ends and is characterized by certain forms of actions such as assassinations, bombings, taking people as hostages, and hijacking of planes. The striking feature is the globalization of terrorism. Most of the countries in the world like Afghanistan, Brazil, Myanmar, Canada, Egypt, France, Germany, United Kingdom, USA, India, Indonesia, Italy and others suffer from terrorist onslaughts. The Ejercito Revolutionary del pueblo (People's Revolutionary Group) of Argentina, the Front de Liberation due Quebec (Quebec Liberation Front) of Canada, the Baader Meinhoff Group (Baader Solidarity Group) of Germany, the Jammu Kashmir Liberation Front, the United Liberation Front of Assam (among others) in India, the Provisional Irish Republican Army (IRA) of Ireland, the Red Brigades of Italy, the Japanese Red Army of Japan, the Palestinian Liberation Movement and other Arab terrorist Groups such as Black September Organisation of Palestine, the Huklalahaps of the Philippines, the Tupamaros of Uruguay, etc. are some of the terrorist organizations in the world which are disrupting peace and security. But the new epicentre of terror since the 9/11 tragedy is the Al-Qaeda and the name associated with it is that of Osama bin Laden. Worldwide improvement in telecommunications, transportation and technology